

interface gives a quick snapshot of the number of tasks and milestones on each day of the month. You also can create a new task, milestone, or meeting directly from within the calendar. In addition to which, you have a discussion forum and project reports in the Gantt chart format.

What we find missing is a method to constrain the tasks to be within the start and end dates of each milestone. Keeping track of the milestone date while entering the task information can become confusing when you have tens of tasks leading up to each milestone. You could end up setting tasks that go way beyond the milestone date without being any the wiser. Similarly, an indication of the daily task load on each assigned user would have been useful, as you need to manually check whether you are overloading work to each user.

These two features aside, Zoho Projects can fit the bill if you need an uncomplicated project management system that multiple users can use without draining your wallet.

7.4.3 Zoho CRM

Businesses have customers. Before they can be customers, though, they need to be found, chased, mollycoddled, cajoled, persuaded, and won over into doing business with you. When you have one potential customer, it's easy. When you have ten, you can feel the sweat have up. Have twenty and you find keeping track of what's happening with each potential a struggle: you begin to keep notes, start using spreadsheets, have calendar reminders, start pinning yellow sticky notes to your fridge door and car dashboard, and start dreaming of software that would make your customer management tasks simpler.

Bang! Enter Zoho CRM.

As customer relationship management applications go, Zoho CRM is feature-rich. It supports both pre- and post-sales customer management as well as order management—right up to invoicing